

5.2 | SPACE

Judging space when you're driving is a valuable skill. It can take time and practice before you're proficient, which is why novice drivers are at a greater risk. You can judge space by distance or time, but you need to constantly evaluate your position on the road. Try to keep plenty of space around you as you drive.

You can reduce your risk and give yourself time to determine an alternative path, if needed, by leaving enough space around your vehicle. It will provide additional room to take action should there be a problem in your path of travel.

When you're driving near other vehicles, it's important to leave a distance that's at least twice the length of your vehicle between you and the vehicle ahead. When merging, give yourself enough space so you safely apply your hazard management routine to **plan, communicate, check, execute**, and **evaluate**.

